

# TAKING THOUGHTS CAPTIVE FOR CHRIST

RENEW YOUR MIND. LIVE FOR HIS GLORY.

*"We take every thought captive to obey Christ."*

2 Corinthians 10:5 (ESV)

## DISCIPLESHIP WHAT IS THE END GOAL?

*Is the goal to become Christlike?  
Or is there something greater?*

KNOW GOD

BE TRANSFORMED

DO HIS WORK

MAKE DISCIPLES

GLORIFY GOD

ALL OF LIFE  
FOR HIS GLORY

### 1 A COMMON ANSWER

*"The goal of discipleship  
is to become more like Christ."*

And certainly God is conforming us  
to the image of his Son.

"For those whom he foreknew  
he also predestined to be conformed  
to the image of his Son..."  
*Romans 8:29*

But is Christlikeness itself the final goal?  
Or is God making us like Christ for something greater?

### 2 WE WERE CREATED FOR GOD

The Westminster Shorter Catechism  
begins with the big picture:

"Man's chief end is to glorify God,  
and to enjoy him forever."  
WSC Q1

Jesus describes eternal life relationally:

"And this is eternal life, that they know you,  
the only true God, and Jesus Christ  
whom you have sent."  
*John 17:3*

The end is not me — not even an improved version of me.  
The end is God and his glory. We were made to know him,  
love him, enjoy him, glorify him — and serve him.

### 3 COMMUNION WITH GOD INCLUDES WORK

We sometimes speak as though the Christian  
story were:

Believe → Become Christlike → Die → Enjoy God

But communion with God begins now.  
And from the beginning, communion with God  
included work.

"Be fruitful and multiply and fill the earth  
and subdue it, and have dominion..."  
*Genesis 1:28*

Adam was created to live with God, under God's authority,  
working in God's world. Man was made to cultivate creation —  
to develop its possibilities and bring them into fruitful service  
for the glory of God.

### 4 REDEMPTION RESTORES THE WORKER

Sin did not merely damage our relationship with God.  
It damaged the image-bearer and therefore  
corrupted the work of the image-bearer.

Redemption restores both.

"For we are his workmanship,  
created in Christ Jesus for good works,  
which God prepared beforehand,  
that we should walk in them."  
*Ephesians 2:10*

God isn't merely preparing people to go somewhere.  
He is restoring people to become something and to do something.  
We are being remade to work, serve, create, build, and multiply  
under the lordship of Christ.

### 5 SO WHAT IS CHRISTLIKENESS FOR?

Christlikeness isn't discarded.  
It is placed within its larger purpose.  
God conforms us to Christ so that we become  
faithful sons and daughters who can increasingly  
think, love, obey, work, serve, teach, and exercise  
responsibility under the reign of Christ.

*We become like the King  
so that we can faithfully serve the King.*

### 6 TAKE THE THOUGHT CAPTIVE



Don't ask only:  
"Am I becoming more like Jesus?"

Ask also:  
"What is Jesus making me like himself FOR?"



#### CARRY TRUTH

God transforms his people not merely to resemble Christ,  
but to live in communion with Christ and faithfully  
accomplish the work he has given them.

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RENEW YOUR MIND. LIVE FOR HIS GLORY.

*"We take every thought captive to obey Christ."*

2 Corinthians 10:5 (ESV)

## TRANSFORMED FOR THE KING'S WORK

*From Communion to Commission*  
A LIFE OF WORSHIP, WORK, AND WITNESS

*"Whatever you do, work heartily, as for the Lord and not for men."*

Colossians 3:23 (ESV)

KNOW HIM

BE LIKE HIM

DO HIS WORK

MAKE DISCIPLES

GLORIFY HIM

SAME MISSION. A GREATER KING.

### 1 THE WORD EQUIPS THE WORKER

All Scripture is breathed out by God and profitable for teaching, for reproof, for correction, and for training in righteousness, that the man of God may be complete, equipped for every good work."

2 Timothy 3:16–17 (ESV)

LEARN  
DO  
TEACH

GOD'S WORD  
DOESN'T JUST  
FILL OUR MINDS.  
IT PREPARES  
OUR HANDS.

### 2 RESURRECTION GIVES PURPOSE

Therefore, my beloved brothers, be steadfast, immovable, always abounding in the work of the Lord, knowing that in the Lord your labor is not in vain.

1 Corinthians 15:58 (ESV)

BECAUSE CHRIST ROSE,  
OUR WORK MATTERS.  
WHAT WE DO IN THE LORD  
IS NEVER IN VAIN.

### 3 THE GREAT COMMISSION

"All authority in heaven and on earth has been given to me. Go therefore and make disciples of all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit, teaching them to observe all that I have commanded you."

Matthew 28:18–20 (ESV)

DISCIPLES MAKE DISCIPLES.  
THE NATIONS ARE DISCIPLED.

### 4 CULTIVATE GOD'S WORLD

"Be fruitful and multiply and fill the earth and subdue it, and have dominion over the fish of the sea and over the birds of the heavens and over every living thing that moves on the earth."

Genesis 1:28 (ESV)

WORK, CREATE, BUILD,  
CARE, DEVELOP, AND USE  
THE RESOURCES OF CREATION  
FOR THE GLORY OF GOD.

### 5 GODLY WORK IN EVERY VOCATION

Whatever you do, work heartily, as for the Lord and not for men, knowing that from the Lord you will receive the inheritance as your reward. You are serving the Lord Christ.

Colossians 3:23–24 (ESV)

EVERY  
VOCATION  
CAN SERVE  
GOD'S PURPOSES  
WHEN DONE  
UNDER  
HIS LORDSHIP.

### 6 ALL FOR THE GLORY OF GOD

So, whether you eat or drink, or whatever you do, do all to the glory of God.

1 Corinthians 10:31 (ESV)

A RENEWED PEOPLE.  
A RENEWED WORLD.  
ALL FOR HIS GLORY.

### TAKE THE THOUGHT CAPTIVE

Don't just ask, "What should I believe?" Also ask, "How does this thought affect how I live, work, and serve for Christ?"

*Every thought brought under Christ's lordship moves us toward faithful action.*

### CARRY TRUTH

***We are being transformed for the King's work.***

In communion with Christ, shaped by his Word, empowered by his resurrection, we faithfully work, make disciples, and exercise dominion in every sphere of life — for the glory of God.